AUGUST 2007

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot Mountain View, California, built in 1888

ANNUAL BARBEQUE AND RAFFLE
AUGUST 5, 2007, SUNDAY, DOORS OPEN AT 1 PM

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY ROBERT WEAVER

For those who could not attend our May quarterly meeting at the beautiful Los Altos History Museum, you missed a tremendous program. Mr. Robert Grimm gave an excellent presentation on how the Los Altos museum was established. Offering insight into the Los Altos process, Robert helped us understand what we will need to do to establish our own museum here in Mountain View. Joining us at the presentation were members of the Mountain View City Council and the City Manager who, along with our members, explored the exhibits, displays and gift shop. The Mountain View Voice published a follow up article about the meeting along with a positive editorial. We deeply appreciate the hospitality extended to us by Laura Bajuk, Executive Director of the Los Altos Museum, and Emily Lewis, her assistant.

We just received assurance from the City Council that our museum will definitely be included in the forthcoming master plan for Cuesta Park Annex. With this assurance, we can now begin the planning and fundraising for the museum.

Our Association has been invited by the Friends of Rengstorff House to participate in their History Day celebration on Sunday, September 30 at the Rengstorff House. Participants dress in period attire and perform tasks from the period. The tasks need to be interactive so that the members of the public can participate. Any ideas?

Bring those ideas and your appetite to our Summer BBQ at the Adobe Building, Sunday, August 5. The Association will be celebrating its 50th birthday. Along with our traditional "zesty" hamburgers we will be having birthday cake and ice cream. There will be beer and wine for sale at the event (bring your ID's -- you may have to prove you are over 21!), raffle prizes and good fellowship.

Lastly, it is with sadness that I mention the passing of Anne Bakotich, a life-long resident of Mountain View and life member of our Association. Anne's passing is a personal loss to us all and we shall deeply miss her. In a larger sense, our loss of Anne symbolizes the passing of an era, a generation of early pioneers settling here, raising their families and building the great city we love. With each loss, our community is diminished, but let us be thankful for, and never forget, all they have given us while they were here.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 Years Ago (1907):

A high grade of wine is produced in Mountain View due to a perfect combination of soil, climate and altitude. One acre of vines will produce, on an average, 500 gallons of wine. The cost of making, including shrinkage, should not exceed 10 cents a gallon, while the price received is 20 to 30 cents per gallon.

Seventh Day Adventists are now holding services in their new church on Bailey Avenue.

The grammar and high school buildings are located on five acres surrounded by evergreen oaks in old Mountain View. Fourteen teachers are employed. Frank Huff, principal of the grammar school, receives $110 each month while his teachers get $70. High School Principal, L. Dornbeerger, is paid $150 a month and his teachers earn $90-$100.

75 Years ago (1932):

John Puppo, the talented young accordionist of Mountain View, is spending his two weeks of vacation in San Francisco. While there, he is engaged for performances at both the Fox Theatre and the Milano Theatre.

New mail rates, effective June 6, require 3 cents per ounce, or fraction of an ounce, for letters and first class mail, while airmail will need 8 cents per ounce.

Chief of Police, W. Evans, reminds residents that fireworks must not be sold or exploded within the city limits.

An average of six iced railroad cars of apricots are leaving for eastern markets each night from the Ice and Pre-cooling Plant at Villa and Mariposa Streets. More than 100 people are employed there.

50 YEARS AGO (1957):

Business Closings: Diaz's Mountain View Shoe Store, 212 Castro Street, announced a "going out of business sale" with all merchandise 25% off. Mountain View Feed and Fuel lost its lease at 1058 Villa Street and closed.

Mrs. Edith Duke is Mountain View's new head librarian.

Mountain View Recreation Department sponsored a six week class teaching 10 to 18 year olds how to train their dogs.

Traffic officer, Marvin Marty, received special FBI recognition for his capture of a bank robber. Hearing that a robbery suspect had just fled the San Jose crime scene in a taxi, Marty headed for Bayshore Highway figuring that might be the get away route. It was and the officer successfully stopped the taxi and arrested the robber.

25 YEARS AGO (1982):

The Flag Team from Mountain View High School (formerly called Awalt) won a "superior" trophy in competition with 40 other teams at a four-day event in Santa Barbara.

Dan Navarro took over as head football coach in place of Rich Ryerson who was with the district for 16 years.

Two hundred irate golfers appeared at a Council meeting to protest the proposed closing of Cherry Chase Golf Course. Two years ago, Dividend Development Company received permits to construct 170 housing units surrounding the greens and promised to continue operating the course. To date, nothing has been built. Insisting that income is too low, the company announced it is closing the 9-hole course and is considering plans for nearly 400 units on the 30 acre site.

The City has to pay an extra amount of money to <u>not</u> accept a new name and logo for the 10-year-in-the-making baylands park. A graphic design firm

recommended the name "Seagrass," which was accepted by a sub-committee and recommended to the full Council. Upset that they had been left out of the decision, Parks and Recreation Commissioners said the name was "unimaginative, indistinctive and inappropriate for a park 60 miles from the sea." It took two months and several votes before the great debate was settled. With "Shoreline" the official name, the graphics firm had to redesign logos, signs and literature and their contract went from $14,000 to almost $21,000.

STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN

No doubt you are familiar with Levin Avenue because of the publicity about the "Pumpkin Patch" location at Grant Road and Levin. But, do you know it was named for Joel Levin (1824 – 1909), an 1852 pioneer whose home ranch was on Charleston Road?

In 1883, he bought additional land on the east side of Grant Road. The property extended clear to Stevens Creek, contained 160 acres, for which he paid a total of $16,000. In 1900, Mr. Levin divided the land into five portions, one for each of his five children. Two continued to own their orchard properties for many years--Ulysses Levin, and at the end of Levin Avenue, Mrs. Mame (Levin) Huff. She was the wife of Frank L. Huff, an early grammar school principal and later postmaster in Mountain View. Their home was moved from its original site and is now located at 2715 Dierix Drive.

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER

From Charles Huff, a retired teacher from the Palo Alto School District, a beautiful framed print of his watercolor painting of the dirigible Macon, which features one of the Sparrowhawk airplanes.

From member Joseph Sweeney, a 1909 songbook of about 100 songs and hymns, which had belonged to Mrs. Roberta (Bubb) Sweeney. Pasted in the back are the words of two Mountain View High School songs. One has the name D. Dale, which would seem to indicate that Dorothy Dale may have written the words. There are also the names: Vera Dean, Dorothy Theurkauf, Ruth Hollingsworth and Pearl Foster (all of the class of 1926).

BACK TO THE EAGLE SHACK BY EUGENE SHARP
To Be Held At The Adobe Building, Oct. 7, 2007, Sunday 2 to 4 PM

Several members of the original Melody Mixers (MM) Russ Holcomb and Charlie Henderson still play their instruments and hopefully can be convinced to participate. Vocalist Lucille Garcia Rodgers and myself have had an informal rehearsal. Several sons and daughters of MVUHS graduates that sing or play instruments might be able join the New Melody Mixers. We plan to start the music with Artie Shaw's Begin the Beguine; the MM theme, Careless; then a progressive dance lead by Keith Bayne to, Night and Day; and When You're Smiling, plus???? Maybe we can convince the Go-Fer Girls to sing their theme song and lead a Conga Line or Lines. Please send any requests for any favorite songs you wish to dance to or hear to Eugene Sharp, 3070 South Court, Palo Alto CA 94306; esharp_f@pacbell.net; or (650) 493-1488.

Dona Hileman Dodson found an article in the Dec. 15, 1949 Mountain Eagle (MVUHS Paper) that describes the coming Christmas Dance at the Eagle Shack, Dec. 18, one day after the MVUHS Christmas Dance; the Shack was also open Dec. 31 for a New Year's Dance. The Shack was a busy place with dances almost every Saturday night. The Shack was run by an Eagle Shack committee that met every Monday evening at MVUHS. I would love to hear from any Shack committee members to help decide what to do at the Shack on October 7, 2007.

Ralph Faravelli, who with others was instrumental in saving the Adobe Building, plans to attend and maybe say something at the beginning. Charlie Olsen of C. J. Olsen Cherries is coming and remembers being driven with friends to the Shack in a special bus from Sunnyvale.

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

President	Robert Weaver
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	Craig Holden
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President (not active)	Nick Galiotto
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Programs & Publicity **	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Laura Brown
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

** *NOTE: We are looking for someone to take over Programs and Publicity. The position may also possibly be split.*

MVHA'S INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT

Ending Balance as of December 31, 2006: $22,097.20
Income: $1,015.35
Expenses: $1,733.39
Balance as of June 15, 2007: $21,379.16

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

A/S = Single Members	119
A/F = Family Members	116
LM = Life Members	122
HM = Honored Members	2 with 359 TOTAL

New A/S Members: Ronit Bryant, Liana Couz, Dona Dodson, Domingo S. Gonzales, Fawn S. Hullquist, Donald Jenkins, Shirley Karkas, Lucille Rodgers, Herbert B. Sutton, Jr., Mark Tuban II and Ruby (Martinez, Tuban)Tull

New Life Members: Cornell and Charlotte Anton

Deceased Members: Antoinette Bakotich, Anthony Radisich and Des Telmont

IN MEMORIAM

ANTOINETTE BAKOTICH was born on December 24, 1916 and passed away on June 1, 2007. Ann (or Toni to some) was born in Palo Alto and moved to Mountain View as a young child. She attended Mountain View Grammar School, Mountain View Union High School, San Jose State and graduated with a Masters degree from U.C. Berkeley. Anne, who lived in the family home all her life, is survived by her niece Pat McKenzie-O'Donnell. Ann worked for 42 years with the County of Santa Clara as a social worker. She was active in St. Joseph's Church, Y.L.I., Napredak Croatian Club, UC Berkeley Alumni Association, was a founding member of the Santa Clara County Credit Union and was also a life member of the MVHA.

ANTHONY RADISICH was born on November 14, 1915 and passed away on June 19, 2007. Anthony graduated from Mountain View Union High School in 1934. He is survived by his wife, his sister and predeceased by his brother Jack Radisich. Besides working on his family's 10 acres of apricot, cherry and almond orchards, he owned and operated Anrad's Hardware store in Mountain View for 43 years. He was a Sergeant in the Army Air Corps in the Pacific Theater during WWII with the 421st Night Fighter Squadron. He was involved with the Civitan Society, the Croatian Fraternal Union, Napredak Club, Slovenian Benevolent Society and the Mountain View Historical Association. He was also a tenor in the Mountain View Senior Chorus.

DESIRE JAMES TELMONT (Des) was born April 29, 1921 in Alameda, CA and died April 26, 2007. He is survived by his daughter, Andrea Van Norman, his sister Evelyn Rezendes and his brother Hippolyte (Hip) Telmont. He was predeceased by his longtime companion, Doris M. Condon, and as such, is survived by her daughter Carol Brainerd and her sons Chris and John Condon. Des was a 1940 graduate of Palo Alto High School. He served in World War II and was a member and commander in the Los Altos Chapter of the American Legion. He also was a member of the MVHA. Des owned and operated a carburetor electric shop on First Street, Los Altos which later moved to Palo Alto. He spent many retirement years restoring and racing classic Crosley cars.

IN CASE YOU LOST THE FIRST BBQ MAILER …

BBQ ORDER FORM

Please Send this Form With Your Check to:
MVHA BBQ
c/o 620 Sierra Avenue
Mountain View, CA 94041-2147

Name: _____ **Phone:** _____

Names of Guests: _____

Number of Adults: _____ **@ $10.00 = $**_____ **PLEASE MAIL BY: 7/24/2007**

Number of Children: _____ **@ $ 5.00 = $**_____

TOTAL AMOUNT ENCLOSED: **$**_____

Mountain View

Historical

Association

ANNUAL BBQ

AND RAFFLE

Sunday, 8/5/2007

DOORS OPEN @ 1 PM

THE ADOBE BUILDING

CORNER OF CENTRAL

ESPRESSWAY &

MOFFETT BLVD.

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME:

ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____

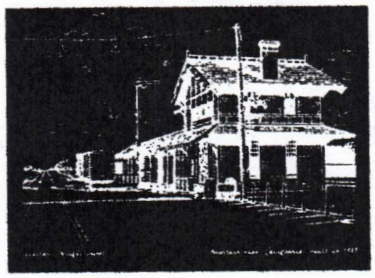
Regular Member $10/year
Family Membership $15/year
Life Member $200.00

Make Check Payable to:

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P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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